

Killer Ad Creatives: Step-by-Step

Research one real customer problem, build one clear angle with visual proof, test it fairly, and let the results write your next brief.

1 Research
customer words

2 Angle
one problem

3 Format
fits the message

4 Build
hook, solution, proof

5 Variations
one change

6 Test
fair, capped

7 Read
whole journey

8 Next brief
repeat weekly

1 Research the customer before opening Canva or a camera

Where to look

- Your reviews, and comments on your ads and social posts
- Support tickets, sales-call objections, post-purchase survey answers
- Reddit threads about the problem
- Competitors' reviews and the comments under their ads: what are their customers complaining about?

Pull out exactly 3 things

- **What does the customer want?**
- **What's stopping them** from getting it?
- **What have they already tried?**

Walking-pad example: *"I sit at my desk 8 hours and barely move"* · *"I want a treadmill but have no space"* · *"It can't be loud on calls"*. Each of those lines is an ad.

2 Pick one problem and write the angle in one sentence

✗ The infomercial

Quiet, compact, easy to store, motor, speeds, warranty, 30-day returns, all in one ad. Nobody who was just watching a cat video will sit through that. Returns and guarantees belong on the landing page.

✓ One argument per ad

"Get more steps while you work, without a giant treadmill taking precious space." Every shot and line in the ad supports that sentence and nothing else.

One product = many angles. Blackout-blind reviews showed buyers using them for nurseries, RVs and truck cabs, and each became its own ad. Get one angle profitable first, then fund tests of the others.

3 Choose the format that delivers the message

Static image

When the value is obvious at a glance and needs no explanation.

Video / UGC

When people must **see** it work: folding, fitting, real-world use.

Product on white + text

Only for high-intent buyers who are already sold. Cold audiences need the picture painted.

4 Build the ad

Ad build card

walking-pad example

Hook	Direct and qualifying: <i>"If you work from home and somehow finish the day with 800 steps when your goal was 10,000, keep listening."</i> The right person stops, and the wrong person scrolls past, which is fine.
Solution	Say it plainly: fits under your standing desk, get steps while you work, put it away when you're done.
Show it	Someone working at the desk → the pad underneath → on a serious call, with the camera zooming out to reveal them walking → putting it away. Little or no text overlay needed.
Proof	For every claim ask "how can I show this?" Compact → show the size. Fits under a desk → show it there. Easy to store → show it going into a closet. Quantified claim → show the real number.
Tone	Clear beats clever. Aim for "this solves my exact problem", not a cinematic ad for everyone. Unproven claims ("life-changing") don't land, especially now that people distrust AI-looking ads.

5 Make variations: same angle, one different thing

Version 1: UGC video

Same angle, same product, same argument.

Version 2: carousel

The slides tell the same story. If one massively beats the other, you've learned something about **format**.

Change hook, angle, audience, landing page, offer and creative all at once, and even if results improve, you won't know why. Keep everything else stable.

6 Test fairly

Creative test

goal: equal exposure, clear answer in 1-2 weeks

Volume	Match the number of ads to the budget. At \$30-100/day , test a focused batch, not 30 ads this week and 20 more next week.
Equal exposure	Put the variants side by side in one test, apples to apples, and cap each ad at 1,000 impressions so spend moves on to the others.
New account	With CPMs of \$50-70 on a fresh pixel, lower the cap to 800 so the test finishes without burning budget. Example: 13 ads at \$30/day.
Don't	Call an ad "not working" after 2 days when it never got spend. Crown a "winner" just because it was the only ad Meta funded.

7 Read the result along the customer journey



10.9% CTR, "satisfying" video

Very high CTR, but it lost 3+ points before the link click and led to almost no buying. It was visually gripping, but viewers never learned what was being sold.

6.3% CTR, routine / before-after demo

Lower CTR, but it lost under 2 points to the link click, and those visitors bought. They knew the product and the result before landing.

1 Did they stop?	no →	Hook or visual is weak	→	New hook / first frame; lead with the pain point
2 Did they click?	no →	Entertaining, but value not communicated	→	Show what they're buying and why it matters to them
3 Did clicks buy?	no →	Don't blame the creative yet	→	Check page speed, landing page, offer, price, shipping
4 Holds at more budget?	no →	Works small, or suits a later funnel stage	→	Use it as a retargeting / lower-funnel ad instead

Two-piece puzzle: cost to get attention × conversion rate. Sending 1M people to a site that converts at 0.5% will never be profitable. A good CPA alone doesn't make a good ad.

8 Turn every test into the next brief

Result → next move

- An angle won → make more creatives on that angle
- One hook crushed → keep it and test 3 different bodies after it
- Demo beat review-style UGC → make more demos
- Competitor reviews show a weakness → answer that objection in your ad

Weekly loop

- ☐ Pull last week's test: CTR, link CTR, carts, sales per ad
- ☐ Note why the winner won (angle, hook, format)
- ☐ Cut the worst ad
- ☐ Brief the next round: one problem, one sentence, one change
- ☐ Re-check customer comments and competitor reviews for new angles

Rule of thumb: choose one customer problem → write the angle in one sentence → make every line of the ad prove it → change one meaningful thing at a time → let the result tell you what to build next.

Built from "How to create killer ad creatives (to blow up your business)" by Sergio C (ADVT Media), 19:46, transcript pulled Sep 2026. All numbers (10.9% vs 6.3% CTR, 1,000 / 800 impression caps, \$50-70 CPMs, \$30/day budget) are the creator's own examples. The troubleshooting order follows the customer-journey questions he walks through.